Cost and Latency Note

Project: Hostel Maintenance Ticket Sorter

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1. API calls per day

The program makes one call to the Gemini AI for each complaint. The input file has 24 complaints, so one day of input needs 24 calls. Each call sends one complaint and receives one JSON reply.

2. Time per call

When the service was working, each call took a few seconds. During the outage, many calls failed with 503 or connection errors, and the program retried them for several minutes. The 5-second pause between complaints is added to every call, so a full run takes several minutes even when the service is fast.

3. Cost per day

The project uses the free tier of the Gemini API, so the cost is zero rupees. The free tier allows 20 requests per day for this model. Because 24 complaints need 24 calls, one full run needs two days on the free tier. The limit resets after 24 hours.

4. Limits and risks

The 503 errors came from the service being busy, and the 429 error came from the daily quota. The program keeps running when a call fails, so a failed complaint is written to needs_info.csv instead of stopping the run. A complaint that fails for this reason needs to be processed again on another day.